Competitive UX Insight

Competitor

Mathrubhumi ePaper

The Hindu ePaper

Hindustan Times ePaper

Indian Express ePaper

Key observation

In this benchmark, The Hindu and HT use reading as an entry point, while Manorama leads with subscription selection.

Manorama: Subscription → edition → plan → payment
Mathrubhumi: Product introduction + subscription/trial
The Hindu: Start Reading → reading experience → subscription
HT: Start Reading → reading experience → subscription

Why its matter

The current subscription-first journey asks users to make a purchase decision before experiencing the core product. For users who are unfamiliar with ePaper, this may create additional uncertainty about what they are subscribing to.

Current experience	Opportunity to validate
Choose a subscription first ⟶	**Experience the ePaper first → understand its value → subscribe.**

This Allowing users to experience a meaningful portion of the ePaper before subscription may increase product understanding and subscription intent.

Current Plan Page — UX Audit

USER Goal

I want to subscribe to the Manorama ePaper and choose the edition and plan I want.

The ideal journey should be:

Understand product → Select edition → Select plan → Understand price/value → Subscribe

UX Issues

1 — The page starts with subscription before product understanding

Now heading is : NEW USER - SUBSCRIBE NOW

Is no meaningful explanation of

- What the ePaper is
- What the user gets
- How the digital ePaper works
- Why they should subscribe

Main Banner communicates features rather than demonstrating the actual reading experience.

2 — Edition selection creates high cognitive load

Observation
A large number of editions are presented simultaneously without prioritisation.

Impact
Users may need additional effort to locate and select their relevant edition.

Opportunity

Prioritise the user's likely edition and simplify edition discovery.

2 — Indian Edition(s) Only is confusing

3 — Selected plan vs selected product state is unclear

Look at the 1-year card
1 YEAR RECURRING PLAN ₹ is visually highlighted.

But

Subscription (0 editions) ⟶ So user see plan selectd but total RS 0
Total Amount ₹0

4 — Recurring Plan" needs clearer explanation

Plan says 1 YEAR RECURRING PLAN and 1 MONTH RECURRING PLAN

But not explain : What happens after the selected period?

For a recurring subscription, users need to understand:

- Renewal frequency
- Renewal price
- How cancellation works

5 — Plan value comparison is weak

Not quickly understand Why should I choose 1 year?

example ₹799/year < ₹67/month

6 — Order summary appears disconnected from the selection

The summary should answer: What am I buying?

Example **Mumbai**
1 Year Recurring
₹799
Total ₹799

7. — E-magazine section distracts from the primary task

Secondary content appears immediately after the subscription module and may compete with the primary conversion journey.

Suggestion

Some users may have a short-term or specific need—for example, accessing today's newspaper or a previous day's edition—without committing to a recurring subscription.

We can Introduce a Single-issue Purchase option alongside the subscription plans.

Very High Priority
High checkout effort before payment

Observation

The checkout requires users to complete an extensive profile and billing form before they can proceed to payment.

Potential impact

The amount of information required at the final conversion stage may create unnecessary friction and increase the likelihood of checkout abandonment.

user already selected my edition and plan. user just want to complete my subscription.

But Instead of: Plan → Pay

Here

Plan → Profile → Billing → Address → Payment type →
Payment gateway → Contact details → Pay